

Rudolph

The Red Nosed Reindeer

Wernard A Broodryk

Revised Edition

Based on the original poem by Robert L. May
1939

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Respectfully retold by
Wernard A. Broodryk
2025

Revised Edition
2026



Preface

It was somewhere between Toronto and Boston, while I was galavanting through the whole world with my parents, that I saw Santa and Rudolph in the night sky.

On account of our intrepid travels — and the fact that I was only 6 or 7 years old — that I just can't remember exactly which window I was sleeping next to when I awoke one magical night and saw the most wondrous thing I had seen until then — or since: there they were, their silhouettes carved out clearly, as Rudolph swiftly led Santa's sleigh — overflowing with toys and candy of course — across the night sky, his bright red nose casting a brilliant light in front of them.

This enigma has lingered for more than 60 years. Every Christmas, I think I still believe I actually saw them: my beloved Christmas friends.

So those warm memories have resulted in this sentimental old fool being totally enamoured with the original story of Rudolph as so beautifully and skilfully rendered for his daughter in poetic form by Robert Lewis May during Christmas in 1939. Pure genius.

So this year I set off to write my own version of the the story, in memory of Mr. May. I am one of many who have attempted to do this of course. His original poem will always stand out as a masterpiece, but I felt if I could tell his story in a different way, without changing the original story line, or taking away from the true intent and heart of the enchanting tale, I could bring honor and meaning to the memory of a marvellous author and bring alive a story loved by millions for close to a century.

WERNARD A. BROODRYK



Christmas 2025



Up on the silver hills where reindeer romp and race,

A happy herd leapt through snow with joy upon each shining face.

They tagged and twirled and tumbled, yet one stayed near the pine,

Young Rudolph stood in quiet thought, his ruby nose a-shine.



Your glaring nose! So big and bright!”

Their tease a constant theme,

He blushed and rubbed his nose with muddy snow

To dull the shameful gleam.

By day it glowed like ember, by night a bright red ball,

Poor Rudolph wiped a tiny tear; his only wish a soft brown nose —

That’s all.

That evening, Rudolph dreamt of Santa's sleigh

With toys and candy flowing,

His sadness faded as he thought how good he'd been -

His heart was overflowing.

He knew that Santa knew his heart, and guessed his deepest longing,

The same was true for all girls and boys who wait

For Santa's coming.





Far north, dear Santa packed his sleigh and gazed into the sky,

A blanket fog had swallowed moon and every twinkling eye.

“Dear Dasher, Dancer, Prancer, Vixen, fly with care tonight,

“Dear Comet, Cupid, Donner, Blitzen; I cannot see our flight!”

So off went Santa and his sleigh with toys a-brimming riding,

Poor Dasher felt like giving up, were it not for Santa's guiding.

They tangled in some treetops, which left poor Comet breathless,

And hardly missed an aeroplane; its pilot smiled,

But still yelled: "Reckless!"





Through fog they reached the reindeer lodge, almost in the dark.

Each room was black as ink — but then they saw a gentle spark!

It glowed beside a little bed, so steady, warm, and true,

The light that softly filled the room was Rudolph's shining hue!



He woke the gentle Dreamer and spoke of children's cheer,

Of waiting hearts and stockings hung, of Christmas drawing near.

"Your nose is not a burden; it is courage, love, and grace,

Will you lead us through the darkness and help us find our pace?"



With awe and wonder the little reindeer stretched,

And hugged old Santa tight,

His unbelief quickly turned: “Dear Santa,

I will serve you true and right!”



“Dear Mum, I’m off to help my Santa.”

He thought to quickly scrawl,

“He asked me to light his sleigh tonight,

To bring good cheer to all!”




Santa







With heart aflame, young Rudolph led the flying Christmas team,
His ruby beacon lighting roof and valley, lane and stream.
Through fog and night they hurried on,
Swift, steady, sure, and bright,
Because of Rudolph's faithful glow,
All children's dreams found flight.

By dawn the world lay golden, the final gift in place,

The fog had fled, the night was done, the sun began its race.

The reindeer who once mocked him stood silent in the snow,

The nose they laughed at saved them all;

Now every heart would know.



“Your courage lit our journey,” said Santa, proud and slow,

“You turned what made you different into the light we know.”

And Rudolph blushed from head to hoof, his spirit calm and bright,

Then softly said, “May Christmas bring to all:

Good wishes, love and light”



So listen close this Christmas Eve, but never take a peek,

For Santa only visits when all children are asleep.

The wind may whisper softly, or the moon be hidden tight,

But Rudolph's hooves might tap your roof if fog has veiled the night.



And if you're still and quiet, as silent as a mouse,

You might just hear him flying swift, around your sleeping house.



His nose will glow through foggy light whereever Santa goes,

And help you see your stocking hung above the fire's glows.

Then when the gifts are placed just right

And dreams are wrapped in sleep,

They'll soar into the fading stars without a sound or peep.

And as they glide past silver clouds in wondrous morning light,

"Merry Christmas to all," they'll sing,

"And to all a sweet good night."




Santa Claus

The End





Father Christmas



Rudolph



Mary Christmas



Blitzen



Dasher



Prancer



Vixen



Cupid



Dancer



Comet



Donner



Playful



Snugs



Pilot



Cheeky



Scepti



Rudolph

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†Soli Deo Gloria